CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

AI Video Storytelling Course Handbook

"Turn ideas into videos that hook, move and travel across every feed."



Video & Creative Storytelling Track | 6 Weeks | Beginner

28-Page Illustrated Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

Course Foreword



A phone and a story are now enough to reach the world. The barrier is no longer equipment or budget, AI has removed most of that. The barrier is knowing what makes people stop scrolling and feel something. That is a craft, and this book teaches it.

We will use AI as a fast assistant, not a replacement for your taste. AI can draft a script in seconds, but your judgement about what is true, local and worth watching is what makes it good. Tools change monthly; the storytelling principles here will still work in ten years.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to build stories that hold attention, use AI to create scripts, visuals, voice and edits fast, and package one idea into clips that work on TikTok, Reels, YouTube and X.

Publish while you learn. A finished, imperfect video that exists beats a perfect one still in your head. Ship, watch what happens, adjust.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 28-page course handbook explains every module clearly with visual diagrams, real East African case studies, and step-by-step labs. Reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Learning Outcomes

01

The hook: win the first three seconds: You have three seconds, use them.

02

Scriptwriting with AI as your co-writer: Brief AI with role, audience, goal, length, tone.

03

Editing for short-form: Cut all dead air, pace holds attention.

04

Tell the story for different audiences: Ship a series, not scattered one-offs.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, each of the 8 modules is given a dedicated two-page spread: first unpacking the concept visually, then walking through a real field scenario and hands-on lab.

By Module 08, you will have built and verified a complete visual story ready to serve employers, clients, ministries, and communities with excellence.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 01: The hook: win the first three seconds | Module 02: Story structures that keep people watching

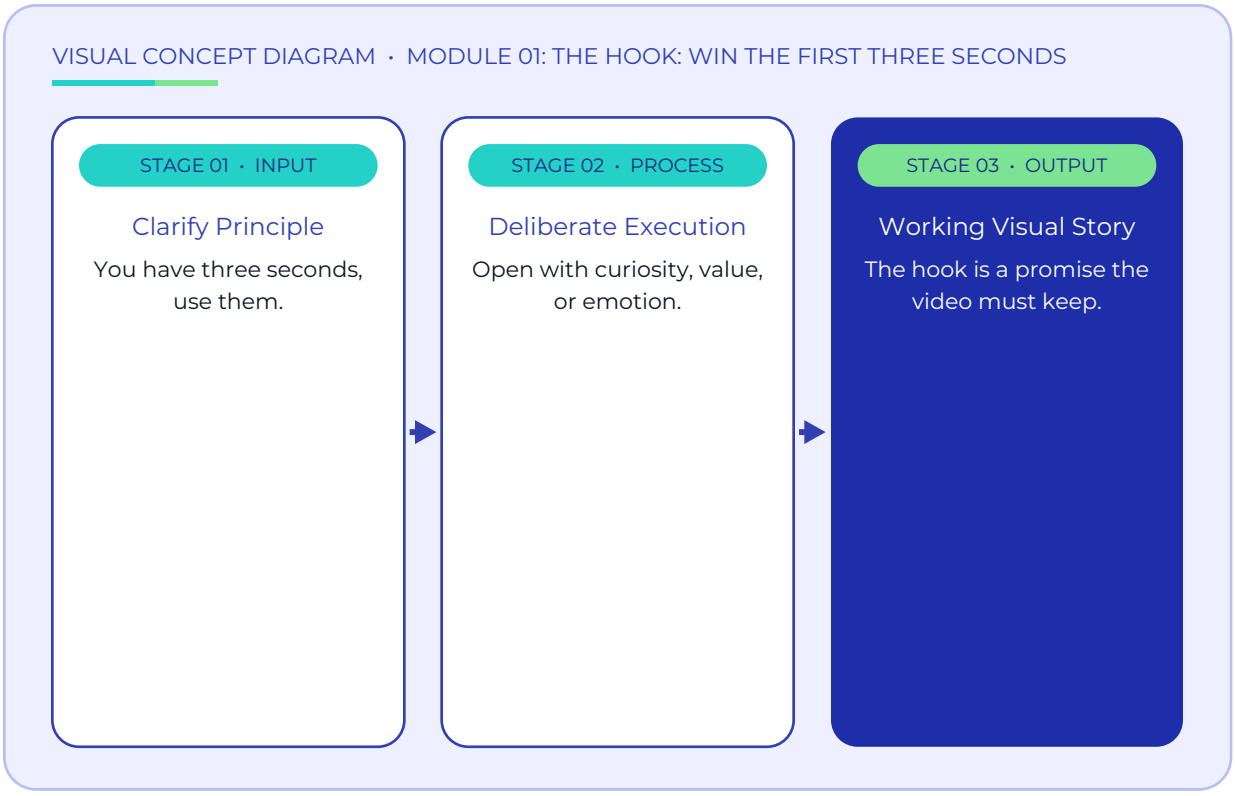
MODULE 01 · PART 1

1.1 The hook: win the first three seconds

On every feed, viewers decide in about three seconds whether to keep watching. If your video opens with a logo, a slow greeting, or 'Hi guys, welcome back', you have already lost most of them. Open in the middle of the action or with a bold promise: 'This mistake is costing Ugandan freelancers money' beats 'Today I want to talk about freelancing.'

A strong hook does one of three things: sparks curiosity, promises value, or triggers emotion. State the payoff up front, what the viewer gets by staying. Then deliver it. The hook is a promise; the rest of the video is you keeping it. Break that promise and they will not return.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *the hook: win the first three seconds* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that you have three seconds, use them., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 01 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Two versions of the same video. Version A: 'Hello, today I'll show my workspace.' Version B: 'I make my full salary from this corner of my bedroom, here's how.' Same content. Version B gets ten times the views because the first line earns the second.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 01

Your Practical Task: Write five different first lines for one video idea. Say each aloud. Keep the one that would stop YOU from scrolling.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 01 Key Takeaways

01

You have three seconds, use them.

02

Open with curiosity, value, or emotion.

03

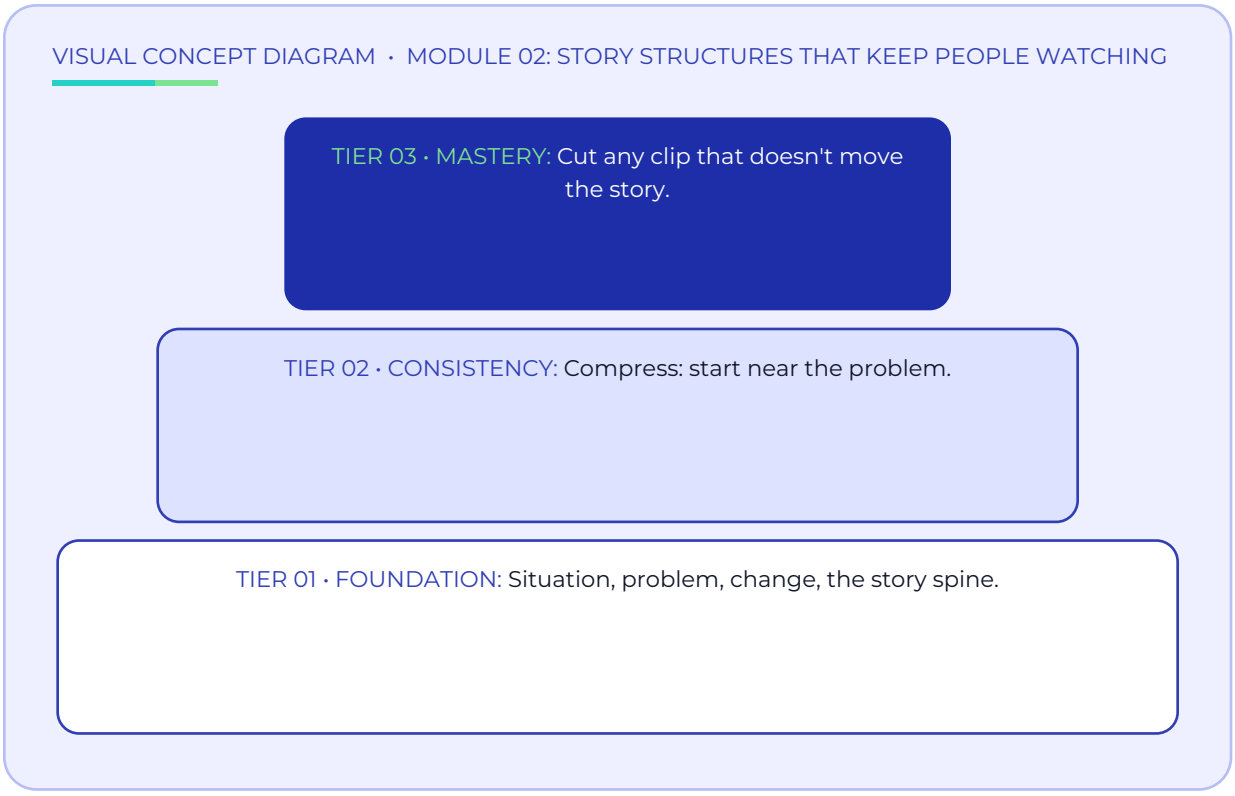
The hook is a promise the video must keep.

1.2 Story structures that keep people watching

Facts are forgotten; stories are remembered. The simplest structure that works everywhere is: situation, problem, change. Show a normal moment, introduce the tension or struggle, then reveal the shift or lesson. Our brains are wired to follow a problem toward its resolution, that pull is what keeps a thumb from scrolling.

For short video, compress hard. You do not have time for a slow build; open near the problem, resolve fast, and end on one clear feeling or takeaway. Every second must earn the next. When editing, ask of each clip: 'Does this move the story forward?' If not, cut it, no matter how much you liked filming it.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *story structures that keep people watching* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that situation, problem, change, the story spine., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 02 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Story structures that keep people watching

Core Rule:
Situation, problem, change, the story spine.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 02 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A 30-second win: 'I was broke and jobless (situation). I couldn't afford a laptop to learn (problem). So I learned design on a borrowed phone and got my first client in six weeks (change).' Beginning, middle, end, and totally shareable.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 02

Your Practical Task: Take a true moment from your life and write it in three lines: situation, problem, change. That is your next video script.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 02 Key Takeaways

01

Situation, problem, change, the story spine.

02

Compress: start near the problem.

03

Cut any clip that doesn't move the story.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 03: Scriptwriting with AI as your co-writer | Module 04: Generating visuals, voice and music

MODULE 03 · PART 1

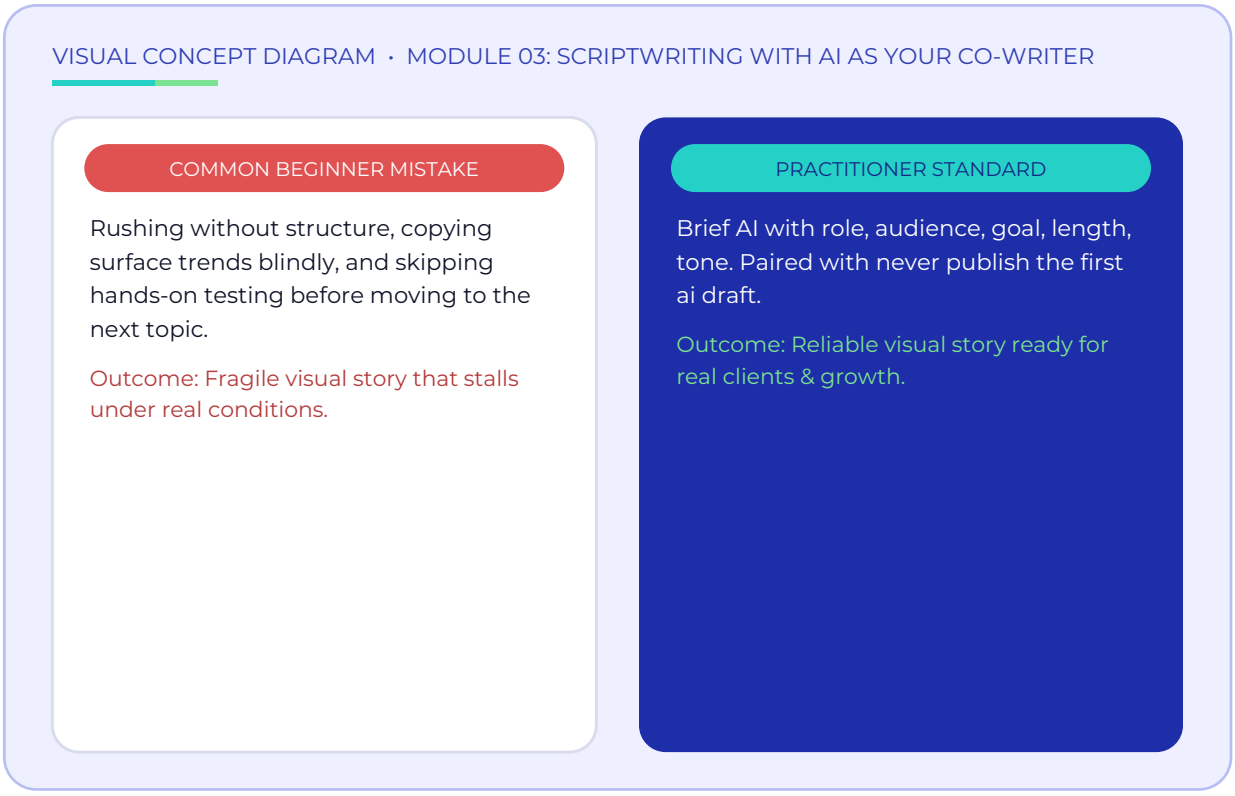
2.1 Scriptwriting with AI as your co-writer

AI writes fastest when you brief it well. Do not ask 'write me a video script.' Give it role, audience, goal, length and tone: 'You are a scriptwriter. Write a 30-second, punchy TikTok script for Ugandan youth about earning online, with a strong hook and a one-line call to action.' The more specific your brief, the less generic the output.

Never publish the first draft. Use AI for speed, then rewrite in your own voice, add your real details, your slang, your numbers. AI gives you clay; you are the sculptor. Read every script out loud before filming; if it sounds like a robot or an essay, cut and simplify until it sounds like you talking to one friend.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *scriptwriting with ai as your co-writer* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that brief ai with role, audience, goal, length, tone., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 03: SCRIPTWRITING WITH AI AS YOUR CO-WRITER



MODULE 03 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Scriptwriting with AI as your co-writer

Core Rule:
Brief AI with role, audience, goal, length, tone.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 03 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A creator asks AI for three hook options and a rough script, then throws away two hooks, rewrites the third in her own words, and swaps the generic example for a real story about her cousin in Jinja. Fast draft, human finish, that is the workflow.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 03

Your Practical Task: Write a detailed AI prompt (role, audience, goal, length, tone) for one video. Generate a draft, then rewrite it out loud in your own voice until it sounds like you.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 03 Key Takeaways

01

Brief AI with role, audience, goal, length, tone.

02

Never publish the first AI draft.

03

Rewrite until it sounds like you, not a robot.

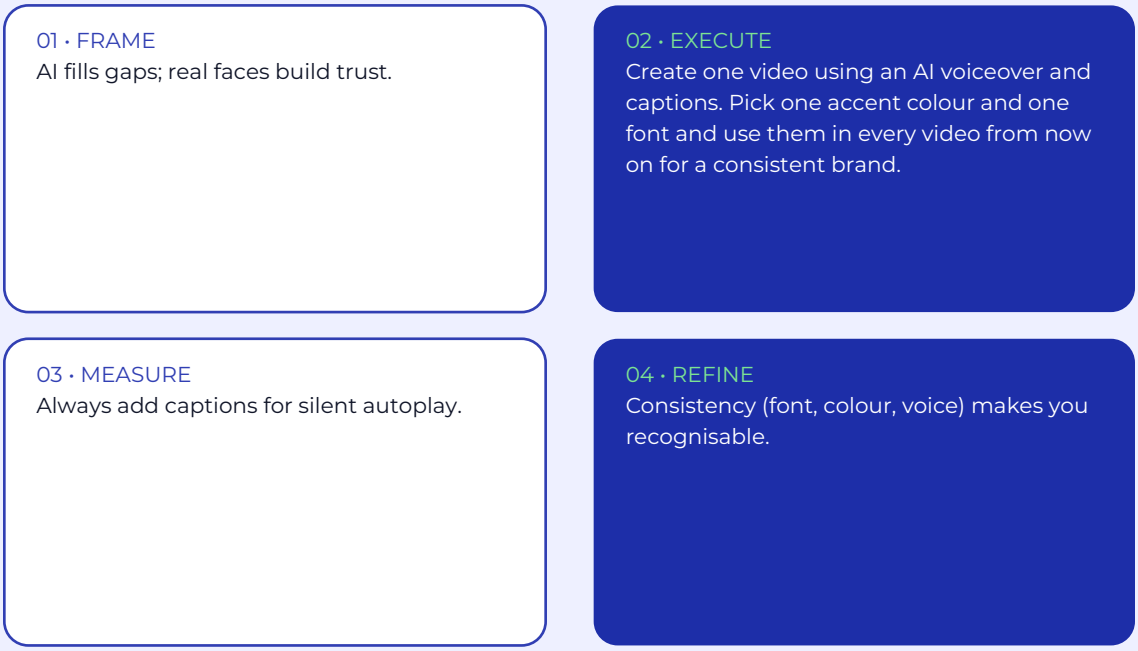
2.2 Generating visuals, voice and music

You no longer need a studio. AI tools can generate images and B-roll, turn text into natural voiceover, and suggest music. Use these to fill gaps, a background scene you cannot film, a voiceover when you do not want to be on camera, captions for the 80% who watch on mute. But keep a consistent look: same fonts, same colour accent, same voice, so your videos are recognisably yours.

Authenticity still wins. AI visuals are best as support, not the whole show; real faces and real places out-perform polished fakes because people trust what feels human. Always add captions, most feeds autoplay silent, and never use music or footage you are not allowed to use, or platforms may mute or block your video.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *generating visuals, voice and music* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that ai fills gaps; real faces build trust., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 04: GENERATING VISUALS, VOICE AND MUSIC



MODULE 04 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Generating visuals, voice and music

Core Rule:
AI fills gaps; real faces build trust.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 04 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A faceless channel about study tips uses an AI voice, simple stock B-roll, bold captions and one signature green colour. It looks consistent and professional on a zero budget, and the creator never shows her face.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 04

Your Practical Task: Create one video using an AI voiceover and captions. Pick one accent colour and one font and use them in every video from now on for a consistent brand.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 04 Key Takeaways

01

AI fills gaps; real faces build trust.

02

Always add captions for silent autoplay.

03

Consistency (font, colour, voice) makes you recognisable.



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 05: Editing for short-form | Module 06: Package one idea for every platform

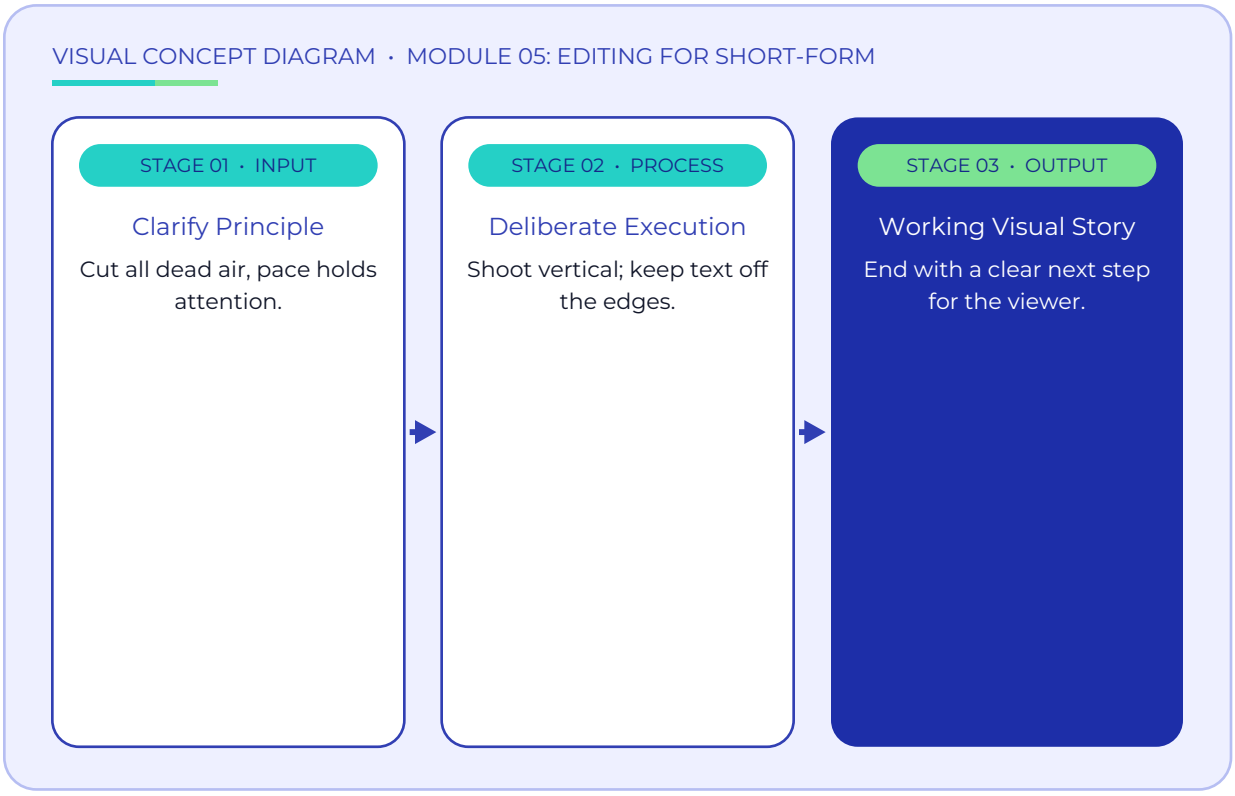
MODULE 05 · PART 1

3.1 Editing for short-form

Short-form editing has one rule above all: no dead air. Cut every pause, 'um', and slow moment. Fast cuts, movement, and changing visuals every few seconds keep the brain engaged. Free tools like CapCut do everything you need, trimming, captions, effects, on a phone. You do not need a computer or paid software to start.

Design for the platform. Vertical (9:16) for TikTok, Reels and Shorts; keep important text away from the edges where buttons cover it. Put your hook on screen as text too, not just spoken. And end with a clear next step, follow, comment, or a question, so the video does a job beyond being watched.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *editing for short-form* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that cut all dead air, pace holds attention., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 05 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Editing for short-form

Core Rule:
Cut all dead air, pace holds attention.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 05 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A creator's views jumped after one change: he started cutting out every silent gap. The content was the same, but the tighter pace kept people to the end, which told the algorithm to show it to more people.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 05

Your Practical Task: Edit one video in CapCut. Remove every pause, add captions, and place your hook as on-screen text in the first second. Compare watch-time to your last video.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 05 Key Takeaways

01

Cut all dead air, pace holds attention.

02

Shoot vertical; keep text off the edges.

03

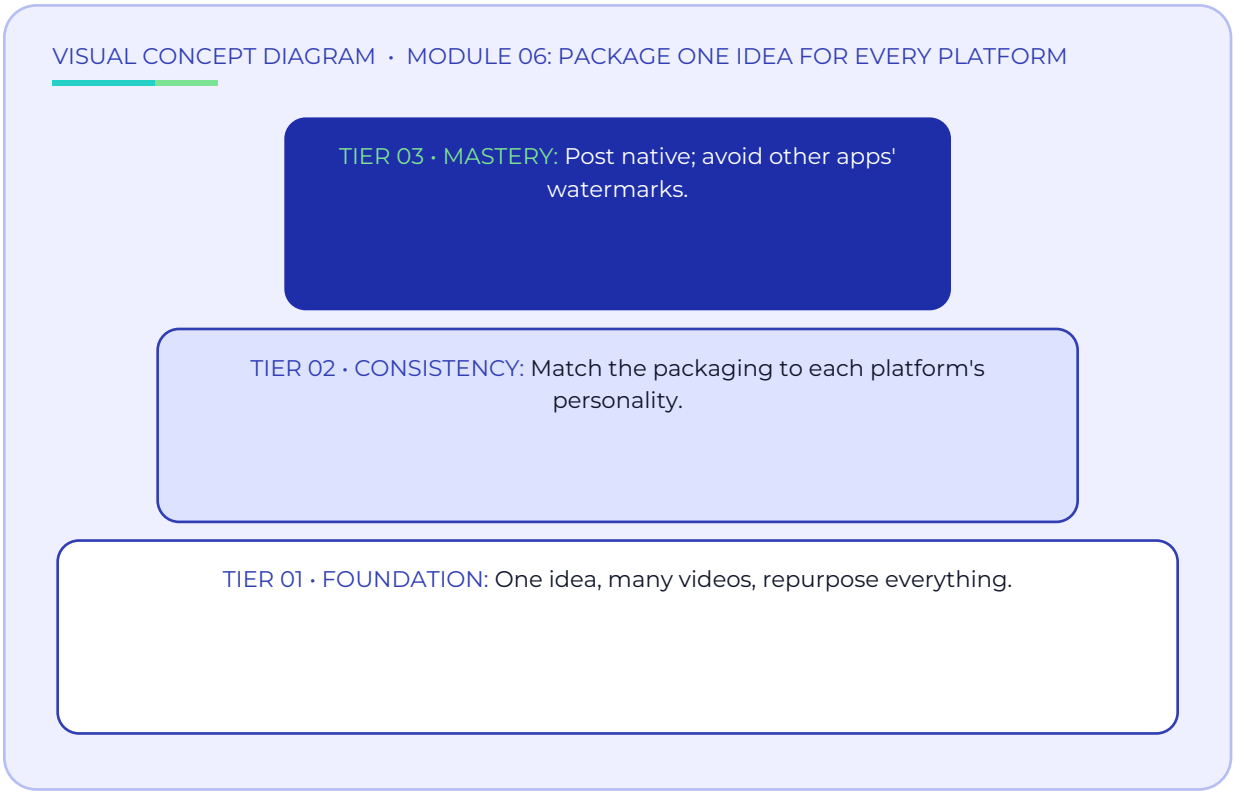
End with a clear next step for the viewer.

3.2 Package one idea for every platform

Smart creators do not make one video per idea, they make one idea into many videos. A single story can become a 30-second TikTok, a 60-second Reel, a longer YouTube version, and a text-plus-clip post on X. This is repurposing, and it is how people seem to be 'everywhere' without working ten times harder.

Each platform has a personality: TikTok rewards raw and fast, YouTube rewards depth and searchable titles, X rewards a strong opinion in text with a clip attached. Change the packaging, the title, thumbnail, caption, length, not the core message. Post native to each platform rather than sharing an obvious re-upload with another app's watermark.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *package one idea for every platform* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that one idea, many videos, repurpose everything., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 06 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Package one idea for every platform

Core Rule:
One idea, many videos, repurpose everything.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 06 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
One lesson on freelancing became: a punchy TikTok hook, the same clip as a Reel with different captions, a 5-minute YouTube deep-dive, and an X thread with the key points. Four posts, one afternoon, one idea.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 06

Your Practical Task: Take one video you already made. Re-cut and re-caption it for a second platform. Notice which version performs better and why.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 06 Key Takeaways

01

One idea, many videos, repurpose everything.

02

Match the packaging to each platform's personality.

03

Post native; avoid other apps' watermarks.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 07: Tell the story for different audiences | Module 08: Publish your AI story series

MODULE 07 · PART 1

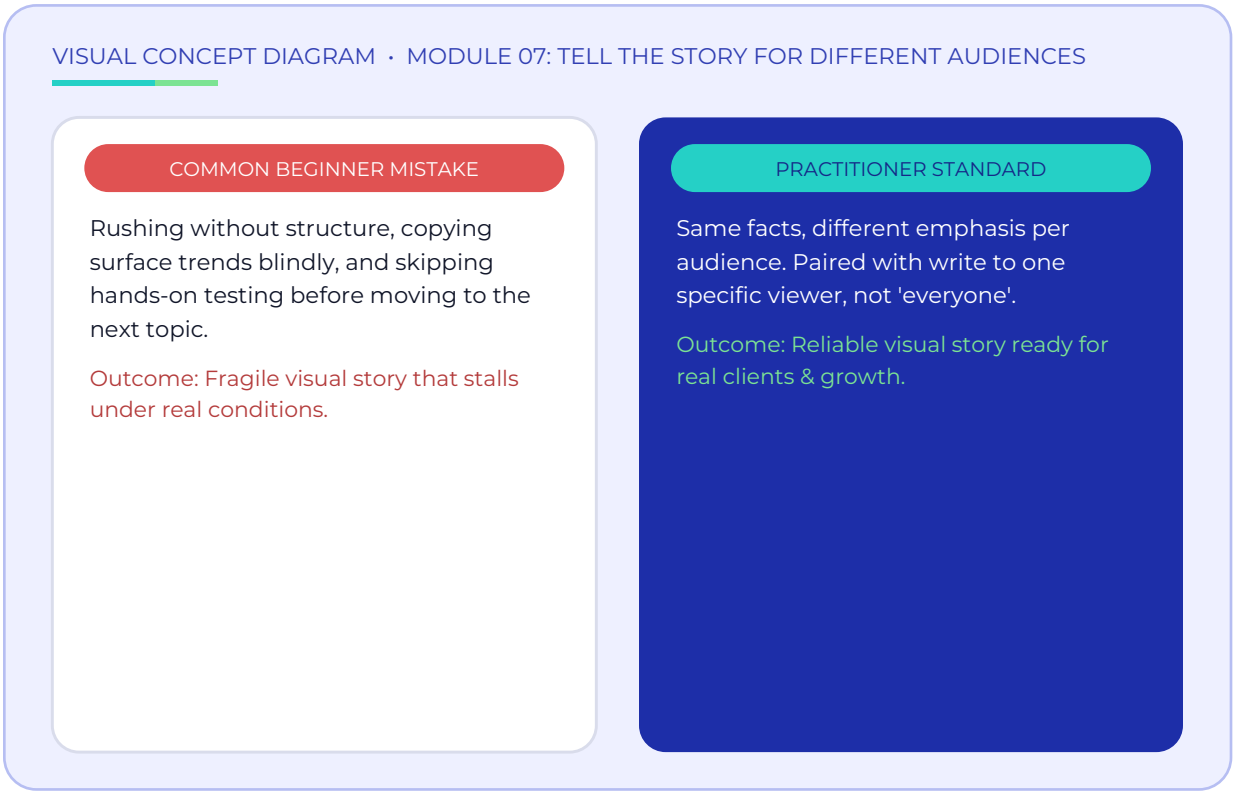
4.1 Tell the story for different audiences

The same message must be dressed differently for different people. A video about your skills-hub aimed at youth should be energetic and aspirational; the same story aimed at a funder or elder should be calm, credible and focused on impact and numbers. The facts do not change, the emphasis, tone and examples do.

Before you film, name your one viewer. Not 'everyone', one specific person: the jobless 19-year-old, the busy shop owner, the sceptical parent. Speak to that single person and, strangely, you connect with thousands. Content made for everyone connects with no one.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *tell the story for different audiences* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that same facts, different emphasis per audience., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 07: TELL THE STORY FOR DIFFERENT AUDIENCES



MODULE 07 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Tell the story for different audiences

Core Rule:
Same facts, different emphasis per audience.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 07 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A hub founder made two cuts of one story. For youth: 'You can earn from your phone, here's proof.' For partners: 'Twenty youth trained, twelve now earning, here's the model.' Same project, two audiences, two winning videos.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT • MODULE 07

Your Practical Task: Take one story and write two hooks: one for a young learner, one for a funder or parent. Notice how tone and detail shift for each.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 07 Key Takeaways

01

Same facts, different emphasis per audience.

02

Write to one specific viewer, not 'everyone'.

03

Aspiration sells to youth; credibility sells to funders.

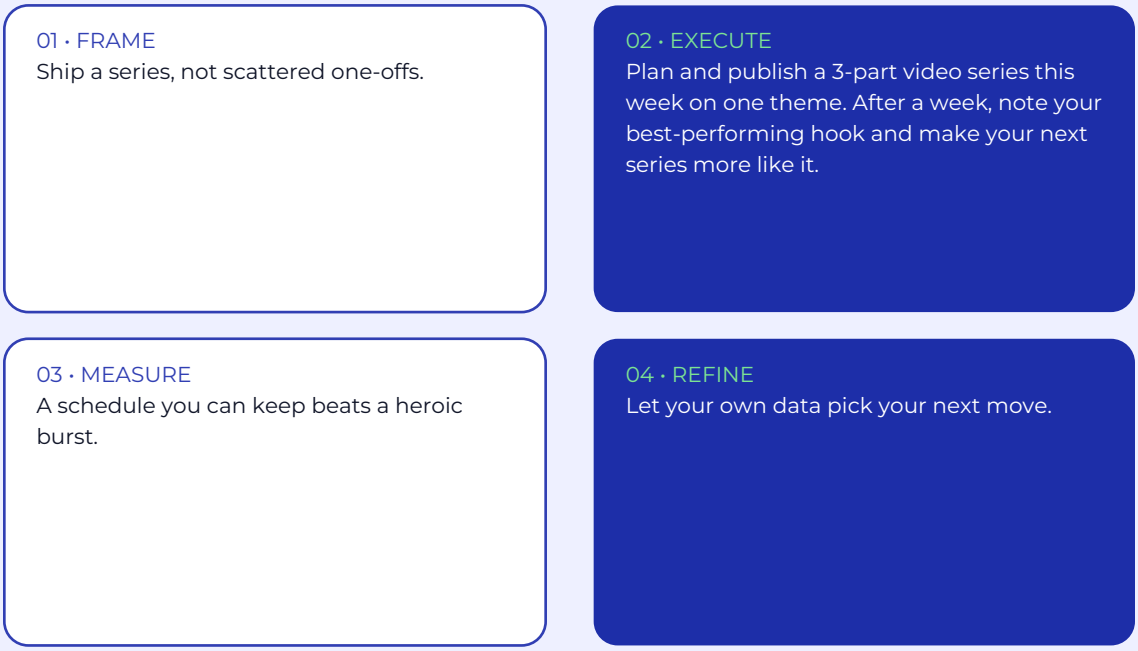
4.2 Publish your AI story series

Knowledge becomes skill only when you ship. Your final project is a series, at least three connected videos on one theme, published on a real platform. A series beats scattered one-offs because it trains you to plan, keeps viewers coming back, and gives the algorithm a pattern to reward.

Set a simple, sustainable schedule you can actually keep, two or three a week beats ten then nothing. Study your own numbers: which hook held attention, which topic travelled. Let the data, not your ego, guide the next batch. Consistency plus honest review is the entire growth formula.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *publish your ai story series* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real visual story. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that ship a series, not scattered one-offs., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 08: PUBLISH YOUR AI STORY SERIES



MODULE 08 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Publish your AI story series

Core Rule:
Ship a series, not scattered one-offs.

Target Output:
Working visual story

MODULE 08 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A learner committed to three videos a week for a month, twelve videos. The first eight were quiet. Number nine hit thousands of views. Without the eight 'failures', number nine never happens. Volume plus review is how you find your winner.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own AI Video Storytelling workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 08

Your Practical Task: Plan and publish a 3-part video series this week on one theme. After a week, note your best-performing hook and make your next series more like it.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 08 Key Takeaways

01

Ship a series, not scattered one-offs.

02

A schedule you can keep beats a heroic burst.

03

Let your own data pick your next move.

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice & Competency Matrix

Review every module in AI Video Storytelling using the table below. Check off each module only after you have completed its hands-on assignment and verified your work against the core principle.

Module	Focus Topic	Core Principle	Workbook Check
Module 01	The hook: win the first three seconds	You have three seconds, use them.	Completed [ ]
Module 02	Story structures that keep people watching	Situation, problem, change, the story spine.	Completed [ ]
Module 03	Scriptwriting with AI as your co-writer	Brief AI with role, audience, goal, length, tone.	Completed [ ]
Module 04	Generating visuals, voice and music	AI fills gaps; real faces build trust.	Completed [ ]
Module 05	Editing for short-form	Cut all dead air, pace holds attention.	Completed [ ]
Module 06	Package one idea for every platform	One idea, many videos, repurpose everything.	Completed [ ]
Module 07	Tell the story for different audiences	Same facts, different emphasis per audience.	Completed [ ]
Module 08	Publish your AI story series	Ship a series, not scattered one-offs.	Completed [ ]

CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO STANDARD

Before graduating from this handbook, combine all eight modules into one finished, shareable visual story: *Plan and publish a 3-part video series this week on one theme. After a week, note your best-performing hook and make your next series more like it.* When ready for mentor feedback, email your work to chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Case Reflections

Real transformation happens when learners turn theory into consistent service. Reflect on these cohort case highlights from across East Africa as you prepare your own project:

STAGE 01

01

"Two versions of the same video. Version A: 'Hello, today I'll show my workspace.' Version B: 'I make my full salary from this corner of my bedroom, here's how.' Same content. Version B gets ten times the views because the first line earns the second."

Cohort Case Reflection | Starting Strong in Module 01

STAGE 02

02

"A faceless channel about study tips uses an AI voice, simple stock B-roll, bold captions and one signature green colour. It looks consistent and professional on a zero budget, and the creator never shows her face."

Mid-Course Breakthrough | Applying Strategy in Module 04

STAGE 03

03

"A learner committed to three videos a week for a month, twelve videos. The first eight were quiet. Number nine hit thousands of views. Without the eight 'failures', number nine never happens. Volume plus review is how you find your winner."

Capstone Completion | Shipping Real Work in Module 08

Stewardship Principle: "Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with excellence, integrity, and faithfulness so your skill becomes a blessing to many."

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in AI Video Storytelling is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 labs and document your baseline specimen in AI Video Storytelling.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Plan and publish a 3-part video series this week on one theme. After a week, note your best-performing hook and make your next series more like it.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO Digital Academy
Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

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shambetz@gmail.com

Official 28-Page Illustrated Course E-Book for AI Video Storytelling (Video & Creative Storytelling Track).
Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES.
For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com. CHRISCO Youth Aflame